

The Get Passive

CEFR B2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

'Get' can replace 'be' in the passive, mostly in speech. Use it for:

- 1 Sudden or unwanted events — He got injured; My bike got stolen.
- 2 Changes of state and set phrases — get married, get dressed, get paid.

The get passive is informal — prefer the be passive (was stolen) in formal writing. Form: get + past participle.

At a glance

be passive	get passive
He was injured in the match.	He got injured in the match.
My bike was stolen .	My bike got stolen .
They were paid on Friday.	They got paid on Friday.

Learning objectives

- Can form the get passive with get + past participle (CEFR B2).
- Can use it for sudden/unwanted events and set phrases.
- Can choose the be passive for formal contexts.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. The Get Passive · CEFR B2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. My phone ____ stolen on the train. (informal)

- A. got
- B. was got
- C. gets
- D. getting

2. They ____ married last summer.

- A. got
- B. were got
- C. get
- D. gotten

3. Did you ____ paid this month?

- A. get
- B. got
- C. were
- D. been

4. He ____ hurt playing rugby.

- A. got
- B. was got
- C. getting
- D. gets

5. I didn't ____ invited to the party.

- A. get
- B. got
- C. was
- D. been

6. Hurry up and ____ dressed!

- A. get
- B. got
- C. be got
- D. getting

7. Which sentence is more FORMAL?

- A. The samples were tested in the lab.
- B. The samples got tested in the lab.
- C. The samples get tested in the lab.
- D. The samples were got tested in the lab.

8. Careful, or you'll ____ lost in the old town.

- A. get
- B. be got
- C. got
- D. getting

9. Correct this: 'He was got promoted last year.'

- A. He got promoted last year.
- B. He was got promoted last year.
- C. He did got promoted last year.
- D. He gets promoted last year.

10. When is the get passive most natural?

- A. In informal speech, for things that happen to us.
- B. In academic writing.
- C. In legal documents.
- D. Only in questions.

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. got** — Get passive = 'got' + participle: 'got stolen'.
2. **A. got** — 'Get married' is a set phrase: 'got married'.
3. **A. get** — Questions use 'do' + base 'get': 'Did you get paid?'
4. **A. got** — A sudden event: 'got hurt'.
5. **A. get** — Negatives use 'didn't' + base 'get': 'didn't get invited'.
6. **A. get** — 'Get dressed' is a set phrase (imperative 'get').
7. **A. The samples were tested in the lab.** — The be passive is the formal choice: 'were tested'.
8. **A. get** — 'Get lost' is a set phrase: 'you'll get lost'.
9. **A. He got promoted last year.** — Get passive: 'He got promoted' (or 'was promoted').
10. **A. In informal speech, for things that happen to us.** — It's informal, for sudden/unwanted events and set phrases.